

PERFECTION, IMMORTALITY, OMNIPOTENCE

Greetings and divine blessings for all of you, my dearest friends. Divine love is like an immense mantle of finely spun gold, permeating the universe, enveloping everything and everyone existing in all of creation. This is an ongoing state of reality, in essence always accessible. It is only the disconnected mind that does not perceive it and moves itself out of grace, as it were. But it is not really removed from it, it only seems that way. And then this illusion becomes reality for the consciousness involved in this narrow illusion. As you grow on your path and find forever more and deeper connections with yourself, with what is now in you, so do you finally connect with that essence of you that is that state of grace that I just described.

Your innermost universe is also the outermost universe and vice versa. There truly is no separation. And as time is an illusion, so is "inside and outside" illusion too -- just as much an illusion as your being separated from that mantle of divine love, which is also you yourself, for you are part of that mantle. It is not only given to you or available to you, you are it.

Now, I know, my friends, these are difficult concepts to comprehend, let alone to experience in your present state, a state in which a condensation of energy and consciousness has created little nuclei, as it were. Perhaps I might use the analogy of an "airpocket" to convey the nature or life of matter. In the immense sea of divine reality there are here and there "airpocket" like formations and configurations that are the products of certain states of consciousness. To those who created this particular condensation, who are in this state of consciousness, the creation seems unique and isolated. Other than it, nothing seems to exist, for what exists produced from other states of consciousness and development cannot be focused on and perceived. The "airpocket" you live in represents your present reality. It may be an entirely different "airpocket" for others whom you can see and hear but who live in a different world and have created a different configuration.

The higher self of man is of course the ever existing grace of God -- this mantle of love, truth, and beauty that permeates all of being. Your higher self knows states of reality that your conscious mind knows nothing about. Only on the journey to your innermost being do you gradually expand the experience and the knowledge that come from your higher self and penetrate the mind of your conscious personality. What the higher self knows to be a fact, to be a reality, becomes somehow distorted, somehow no longer quite what it is in the limited state of perception of the conscious mind. In other words, when the knowledge of truth, the knowledge of the higher self is perceived through the maze of the ego consciousness, the same knowledge becomes somehow untrue, somehow distorted.

In tonight's lecture I will speak about three such particular states of reality which in the higher self are beautiful but in the ego consciousness become untrue, off center, distorted, and what you may call neurotic. They therefore must be abandoned first on that level of consciousness before

they can reemerge as truth on a deeper level of consciousness. This is very important to understand. Man constantly battles because he always assumes that something is either right or wrong. Yet one and the same thing can be truth on one level and untruth on another.

The three aspects I want to discuss in our lecture this evening are perfection, immortality, and omnipotence. Let us see how these three states of reality compare when they are experienced in the higher self consciousness and when they are experienced on the personality level. I venture to say, my friends, it will help you a great deal if you really assimilate what I attempt to give you here. Let us begin with perfection. The striving of the higher self for perfection is of course a legitimate movement. For the soul knows that this state of reality exists as a living, breathing reality of its own. This perfection of the spiritual entity is very different, however, from the way the ego conceives of it. Perfection in reality is an ever changing flux. There is nothing static about it. One thing is not in opposition to another. Truth, beauty, love are ever changing manifestations, changing always appropriately to the occasion. Therefore perfection is a constantly moving state. Perfection conceived of by the ego consciousness is static, very limited and exclusive, rather than inclusive. Therefore it deteriorates into perfectionism. When this happens, duality takes its toll. One thing seems good, while another bad.

Striving for perfection from the ego point of view must be given up in order to truly reach the perfection of the higher self. Let us consider the motives for perfection on both levels -- that of the conscious ego personality and that of the higher self. Let us also look at some of the qualities and traits manifesting in both these states.

The motive -- if there is such a thing from the higher self point of view -- for being perfect and wanting perfection is love. It is the recognition that only in a state of pure love can creation be furthered, can the great evolutionary plan be aided. God is perfection; therefore the Godself is perfect -- in wisdom, love, beauty, unity, all-inclusiveness, undivided reality in which what is good and desirable for one must also be so for all others. It is a relaxed state of being in which no fear, pride, or self-will exist. It is for its own sake -- simple and pure. It harbors within itself a state of deep self-recognition that contains respect and love for the self as much as for all other creations. Hence no proving is necessary. It is wide open and knows no formula and no rigid rule. The inner freedom and security make it possible for the entity to spontaneously decide when to be soft and when to strongly assert a position. There is no maudlin sentimentality that fearfully shrinks from confrontation. The courage to risk rejection for the sake of help and truth exists without becoming an extreme position of punitive self-righteousness. Expanding, giving, joyful vigorous expression of divine reality surge forth in the state of positive aggression as well as in the state of soft receptivity and acceptance. Perfection is a breathing, living force that heals, grows, creates because it exists for its own sake. In that state it constantly expresses a variety of divine qualities, not only love, truth, justice, beauty, but also creative vigor, vitality, myriad expressions of self, of life forever alternating for the deeply innate purpose of spreading divine reality into all of the void. This is a very limited explanation, my friends, for human words do not exist to describe this state. So you need to use your innermost feelings, the intuitive faculties of your inner soul to feel what I mean to convey here.

Now how does the striving for perfection look from the level of the ego personality? What are the motives? What are the attitudes? Obviously there is pride -- the need to be perfect in order to be better than others. In that feeling, there is already a total distortion of reality -- a distortion that is again very difficult to convey. All I can say here is what I often mentioned: when you

compare in this manner, you are in the illusion that there is a limited quota of perfection available so that you have to jealously guard your own and take it away from another in order to reach your goal. At the same time, another person's already developed state appears to diminish you. So your attempt to become perfect at the expense of others obviously defeats your very aim, for nothing could be less perfect than the inner greed, jealousy, envy, tight ambitiousness and vanity involved here, not to speak of the very imperfect, limited view of life in which such exclusiveness seems a reality to you.

Another distortion in striving for perfection on the personality level is the fear of the inner imperfection, the hidden sense of worthlessness that is never squarely faced, comprehended, worked through in its details and small everyday manifestations. Instead, a mask of perfectionism is put on in order to prove to the world and the self that this feared and suspected worthlessness does not exist. Perfection then becomes a superimposed solution for the worthlessness that you do not want to experience and examine. So we are also dealing here with evasion, untruth. You are untruthful in the sense of not wanting to see what you really feel and think about yourself, but rather pretending by striving for an appearance. On the ego level, perfection becomes, or is, an outer-directed thing for the sake of others, for the sake of appearance.

So if perfection, a divine state, is being sought in a state of untruth, the false search must lead to a rigid distortion, truly a caricature of the real state of perfection. In this prideful, fearful, untruthful attitude, you also lack faith in your own deeper nature; therefore you hurriedly try to pretend being in a perfect state that has not developed organically. The pretense of appearing perfect (this may apply to specific aspects of the personality and not so much to the total personality) implies a deep dishonesty on the part of the lower self. It is truly cheating by wanting to skip the laborious work of becoming and by wanting to attain the desirable result without paying the price. This, in turn, increases guilt and a sense of worthlessness that is diffuse and not pinpointed in conscious awareness.

The superimposed perfection -- or rather perfectionism -- is always blind, unsure, and therefore rule-bound. It uses truth often in a misplaced way, in generalizations that do not fit the occasion. The self then becomes at times wrongly soft where confrontation and assertion would be appropriate, and intolerant and judgmental where acceptance would be appropriate. For many personalities, one or the other of these two attitudes seems to be "godly" or "right" and is blindly used because it has become structured into the personality. Since the deep lack of faith in the self is not faced, it is always projected outward in an attitude of being cynical and negative toward the world. Alternatively, a false appearance of faith can be put on. The self-judgments that are not being faced openly, distort the personality into becoming self-righteously severe with others. Religionists often distort reality in that way and rationalize their narrow attitude by using religious doctrines. Yet it is also possible to project self-indulgence and guilt in a different way by becoming overly permissive and sentimental so that a false, mask self-acceptance develops that is only an appearance.

You can see, my friends, very clearly that the claim for perfection must be abandoned for the sake of the truthfulness and humility of accepting your imperfection. And that is indeed the threshold through which you must go in order to gradually make room for the ever existing and unfolding perfection of your soul, a perfection that will be experienced so differently when you approach it in this way. The humility of giving up perfectionism, the honesty to pay the price for

developing slowly into a more genuinely perfect being are indispensable prerequisites -- are, in fact, aspects of perfection already. It may seem paradoxical: by accepting humbly your limitations, your imperfect state and looking at it creatively, constructively, and specifically so as to understand and make connections, it is already a manifestation of the Godhead within.

Now let us come to immortality. Again, the state of the soul, the state of reality that the higher self knows to exist is immortality. However, when the consciousness is disconnected from the higher self, the message of the higher self becomes warped again, and the translation of this awareness reaches the conscious thinking process as fear of death, just as the message of the higher self that perfection is possible reaches the conscious personality as fear of imperfection. The fear of death really says, on the deepest level: "I want to experience the state of immortality that I know exists, even though I am caught temporarily in the dualistic 'airpocket' of life versus death -- an either/or." In that experience, in that vision, when you are in one, you do not see the other, and you fear giving up one for the other.

Fear of death also implies lack of faith in the ever ongoing reality of all life, all consciousness. However, when self-will and fear motivate the conscious mind of the outer personality, this truth of immortality is distorted and looked for in order to avoid the fear of death. Adopting spiritual truths, spiritual principles of immortality in order to deny the feeling in which fear of death may still exist, is a neurotic manifestation. The personality fears to go through the tunnel of his own fear. Only when that tunnel is faced with courage, as all feared feelings must be, and is gone through, will the eternal life become an experienced reality, whether you are in the body or outside the body.

The motivation for believing in immortality plays a tremendous role here. If you hide your fear of death, your lack of faith, your own disconnectedness from your inner creation of this dark fear, and superimpose on them the truth from outside, you should abandon immortality and accept mortality until you can truly become immortal.

And now let us look at the third of this triad: omnipotence. Again, the state of ultimate reality of the soul knows its own omnipotence, its own Godness, knows of its power to create, the power to heal, the power to create worlds and to recreate the self in myriad joyful forms and to dissolve these forms and to recreate them. This state of omnipotence is vaguely perceived in a distorted form, like the other two, by the conscious personality. When this distorted message from the higher self state comes through the thin funnel of the channel that exists as yet very narrowly, its manifestation then is the childish claim for omnipotence that you all know exists in infants and that exists in the infantile aspects of the adult as well. In that distorted, immature state, the self-will dictates total omnipotence: "I want it my way. There must be no obstacles, no delays regardless of the cost to others. I want my will immediately, regardless of the consequences." That sense of omnipotence of the outer personality is an insistence on magical solutions that are supposed to eliminate dealing with the self-created reality now: for example, the need to deal with frustration, pain, difficulties, struggle, to learn from them, grow from them, etc.

Obviously this is destructive. It implies selfishness, lovelessness, ruthless disregard for others to the point of cruelty, unrealism (the belief that the obstacles can disappear by a sheer act of will rather than by learning from them through acceptance and thus transcending them), a limited outlook on the reality of creation, lack of trust or faith, and again the cheating that wants to avoid the labor of the struggle of growth.

It is therefore obviously necessary for the growing, maturing individual to abandon his claim for omnipotence and magic along with all the negative traits that are inherent in this claim -- and to have the humility to accept his own limitations. Once you do this, you can go through the doorway and expand gradually your own power to create. But this expansion occurs then on that other level, in a totally different way.

The motive on the higher self level for experiencing the true divine state of omnipotence has nothing to do with pride, self-will, or fear. It does not exclude others, it always includes them. It is again a powerful bright force of self-expression that never infringes on others. The omnipotence attempted by the immature state always infringes on others and wants to limit them for the sake of its own greater power. It tries to subjugate others as the tool for its own omnipotence. The divine state of omnipotence enjoys the equal omnipotence of others; there is never a power struggle between entities in this state.

So let us see, my dearest friends, how you need to give up a state in order to regain it on another level, in a different way. You need to lose sight, temporarily, of the goal. You need to give up your claim for perfection for the ego reasons of fear, pride, comparison, vanity, fear of your own insufficiency. You need to have the humility to see your imperfections, and that in itself is the surest, fastest way to make you more perfect.

Your belief in immortality needs to be abandoned temporarily even though it may be quite accurate, because in spite of these beliefs you still cannot conceive of the change, the switch of consciousness on a feeling and experiential level that takes place when the body is left behind. These are still only words for all of you. And when you use these words in order to deny your vague unrest, your anxiety, or your fear -- the fear of that unknown state caused by superimposing on it true principles and the facts of the greater life -- then it is important that you temporarily give them up. Then you need to admit your fear, your puzzlement, your state of anxiety, the total feeling of being at a loss. For you are truly confronted with a wall through which you cannot penetrate as yet. It is true that this wall is of your own making. It is true that the wall is a result of your disconnectedness and the turn your mind has taken in the particular "airpocket" of your condensed reality. However, that self-created wall can crumble only when you accept its existence and let yourself feel the feelings that this self-created wall elicits in you. So you need not abandon the ideas, but you need to admit that the ideas are only ideas for you and that your feelings are far removed from them and that you do fear that black wall of the unknown which you must traverse.

You have to go through similar walls of the unknown practically every day of your life if you wish to live fully and not in self-limitation and self-deprivation. The more you do this willingly, the more the walls will dissolve, even the great wall. This will make it possible even while living in the body to truly experience this switch of consciousness. You traverse walls of unknown terror in your pathwork as a result of your commitment to your feelings, feelings that you had denied: pain, hate, self-rejection, guilt, rage, all shades of fear and terror, as well as the even more feared feelings of love, sexuality, bliss, oneness. As you learn to travel through these feelings in spite of the initial fear to do so, you traverse black walls and you experience a wonderful new freedom, a wonderful liberation and enrichment. A previously unknown state becomes a known state. It does no good to tell yourself how you believe that these feelings are not to be feared, and then avoid experiencing them, avoid going through the dark tunnel they seem to be. Only when you travel through these

feelings are you truly free of them so that the fear of them will never return to the same degree. As you repeat this every time a residual fear of any feeling surges up again, eventually no residual fear of any feeling or state will remain. It is the same with the great fear of the apparent final tunnel.

When you embrace expansion into new territory in your daily life, when you stop hindering your expansion because you have the basic faith and courage to go into an unknown state, you make the unknown into a known. Every feared unknown -- whether it be a feeling that you designate as being negative or whether it be an expanded new state of experience that is truly positive -- seems to you a black wall that you fear and wish to avoid and therefore wish to prevent your ever flowing movement of life from taking its natural course. So, by abandoning temporarily the outer belief, or hope, or principle, or theory of immortality and accepting your fear of mortality, you can go through a black wall and truly realize immortality as an experienced fact. The same with perfection, with omnipotence, or with many other states of reality not discussed here. For that matter, it is also true of the feelings you are terrified of. Once you traverse them, you will experience the true state that really proves that these feelings are not to be feared.

As to omnipotence, you are already working extensively on your path. You discover the infant in you that demands omnipotence and magical solutions. You express these claims and desires and the rage when these desires cannot be fulfilled. You learn to accept the limitation of your present personality. That personality is limited. You need humility to accept this. You need faith to give up what you believe you must have right now, especially if it is a forceful movement that disregards the rhythm of life, of your life, and the lives of others. Only by that action of love, trust, decency, honesty, and humility can you then come back to omnipotence in an entirely new and different way. You are already discovering increasingly new strength, new creative power, new abilities, new intuitive faculties that you never thought possible before. They are a direct result of giving up the false version of perfection, immortality, omnipotence -- and of other states into which you need to develop gradually.

You can see, my friends, when states of reality on the level of cosmic truth and creation filter through the limited opening into the ego personality and are misunderstood and distorted by the conscious personality, these same states that are divine truth become lies and neurotic manifestations.

Mankind's confusion of these states at this point of your time, of your history, is very significant. Let us shed light on the evolutionary movement in this respect. In previous times, when religion was strongly represented in the life of humanity, truth was postulated. Humanity, at that point in its development, had to first intellectually consider these principles that could in no way be followed emotionally. But it was a necessary beginning at a certain stage of development. It is always thus: first a new idea has to be considered before it can be incorporated into the deeper consciousness. These new, truthful ideas must come from the outside in order to facilitate the opening of the channel so that they can then be borne out and experienced from the inner self. Higher developed factions of the inner religious movements always knew that these states of perfection exist within man as a potential to be realized. They always knew that God is within, and they always postulated this. However, at that time, it could not be more than a theory and a far-away goal. This truth was then misunderstood, misrepresented, and misused by the prideful, domineering, fearful ego so that perfect states were forced, pretended, punitively dictated in order to allay the fear of facing the places where these states could not yet exist within the personality.

This abuse and misuse, this dangerous escape from the necessary developmental steps necessitated a new movement in your history which came along with psychology. As psychology developed, these distorted manifestations were recognized by it as being illusory pseudo-solutions. They were designated as neurotic states that the individual who became more mature naturally abandoned, at least to some degree. In the best of instances, there was an acceptance of limitation, imperfection, and mortality through psychology.

Then, however, this very important psychological movement also began to deteriorate as a result of the dualistic state in that it lost sight of the fact that yet another step existed. Yet another level had to be reached in which the false became true again. In regard to the triad of this lecture, perfection, immortality, omnipotence truly exist. So a total denial of these states by psychology is equally untrue, although at first necessary in order to follow the curve of growth.

In the new age in which everything leads to a discovery of and a fusion with the inner levels -- a fusion of the dualities, of the either/or principle -- it will be found that neither are you perfect, nor do you give up perfection forever. Neither are you now immortal, nor do you give up immortality forever. Neither are you now omnipotent, nor do you forever remain limited and separated. You will find that different truths apply to different levels. On the outer level of your personality you are indeed not perfect; you are indeed mortal; you are indeed far from being omnipotent. But contained within you exist already absolute perfection, immortality, and omnipotence. But only as you abandon your insistence of possessing them right away will you even know what is perfect and what is not perfect; what is life and what is death; what is power and what is weakness.

When you are in the dualistic confusion, you do not know. You often think you know what is perfect and imperfect, but you do not because you do not understand and cannot see far enough into the chain reactions. You do not perceive the dynamics. You often believe something is death when it is really life, and life when it is really death. For example, when you deaden your faculty to feel and your faculty to deeply experience and vibrate with life, you think you are alive. And when you slip through the gate, you think you are dead. Even during life in the body, you believe that experiencing your pain and terror, your imagined worthlessness is death, that it will annihilate you. When you muster the courage to go through it in a real way, you will find that you have gained new life. In fact, in those very feelings you feared as death itself is so much of the life energy, so much of the contained vitality that you have deliberately deadened. So you see, my friends, even knowing what is the one and what is the other cannot truly be possible on the level of personality, of the conscious mind now. In knowing this, you will perhaps gladly learn not to insist any longer on the perfection, the immortality, and the omnipotence that grow out of fear, lack of faith, self-hate, limited vision, pride, impatience, distrustfulness. You will learn to abandon them as you go through the feelings that create the urgency to be in these states. Thus you will traverse gates, tunnels, and walls.

There is another aspect about the connection between the conscious mind and the higher self. As you can perceive quite clearly from the foregoing, when the connection is partial and if the fact that it is only a partial connection is not clearly comprehended, damage might occur. The same process I explained with these three aspects can exist in many other ways. I do not mean in the least to imply that the conscious mind should not attempt to connect with the higher self -- quite the contrary, of course. But what is important is to know that a beautiful opening in one area is no

guarantee that a similar opening exists in all other areas. There are human beings who have established a good channel and connection with their own higher self. In that area it may be a flowing, beautiful channel where the conscious mind can indeed be inspired, guided, instructed by the inner God. However, if the conscious personality then believes that this fact means that he or she is now truly "safe" and has, in all areas, the connection; that could become a danger. Where the disconnectedness exists, the channel is not open and cannot come through, no matter how open and truthful it may be in another area. It is a great mistake to assume that an open channel guarantees that it can truthfully instruct or even point out the blind spots that still exist in the personality. Where the personality is still resistant, blocked, defended, and has a stake in not knowing or admitting this attitude, the open channel cannot function.

This is a specific danger point on the road to opening the channel. Many have faltered here. Before such a channel opens up, this danger does not exist to the same degree -- then, other dangers exist. But once a channel has been established, the belief somehow exists that the divine self that functions and communicates so beautifully can point out wherever the blind spots are. Such a person will then become self-enclosed. The still existing pride may close him or her to any help from others outside who may point out better what the channel cannot reveal. Now that more of you experience this newly awakened channel as an immense source of joy and strength, let me particularly warn you about this so that the pitfalls can be avoided. Many highly developed spiritual innovators and channels have late deteriorated because of the ignorance of these dynamics. The inner God never forces something on the self that the self does not actively seek. This is a law that is never broken. This is why continuing the pathwork with a helper and your friends in groups is so essential -- perhaps in a different sense -- even more after the channel begins to work.

Ask yourself deeply, where do you still resist and defend, where do you hold on and have a stake in not letting in anything that might seem threatening to you? To the degree you can acknowledge that such an attitude exists, you are already better off, for you have then the tools to work on it and can understand that this limits your perception of reality and your channel to your higher self. Even where the open channel already functions, it might be mistranslated and misused in order to perpetuate the resistance. Such distortions not only exist in regard to the triad I discussed here but in many areas of life too numerous to list here. But be aware of this possibility! An incomplete opening and state of receptivity, a state of defendedness distorts the messages from the higher self, whether they come in a longing, a striving that is not articulated, or in actual instructions and words.

Your path is indeed a blessed, blessed venture. If only you could see the difference of your inner landscape already after the initial steps you have undertaken -- and they are always the most difficult steps. And if you could only see the still more glorious, expanded inner landscape that will become your own home ground when your commitment to all of yourself and to the truth of all being is constantly renewed and rooted in you; if you learn to have faith in periods of darkness in your life, these very periods will (and already have) shorten as your path progresses. They become less fearsome and less frequent. Continue on your beautiful journey, there is no better one. All of you are blessed in the deepest possible way. You incur an extended blessing for every step on your way, in love and in faith. Be your God.

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